



## TURKEY

**Capital city:** Ankara

**Area:** 301,382 sq miles  
(780,580 sq km)

**Population:** 71,300,000

**Official language:**  
Turkish

**Major religions:** Muslim  
99%, other 1%

**Government:** Multiparty  
democracy

**Currency:** Turkish lira

**Adult literacy rate:** 87%

**Life expectancy:** 70 years

**People per doctor:** 769

**Televisions:** 286 per 1,000  
people

## CYPRUS

**Capital city:** Nicosia

**Area:** 3,571 sq miles  
(9,250 sq km)

**Population:** 802,000

**Official languages:** Greek  
and Turkish

**Major religions:** Greek  
Orthodox 85%, Muslim  
12%, other 3%

**Government:** Multiparty  
democracy

**Currency:** Cyprus pound  
and Turkish lira

**Adult literacy rate:** 97%

**Life expectancy:** 78 years

**People per doctor:** 381

# TURKEY

TURKEY LIES PARTLY IN EUROPE and partly in Asia and is divided by a narrow waterway. For more than 600 years, Turkey was part of the powerful Ottoman Empire. Today, Turkey is a republic and the country is a mix of Islamic and Western traditions. Most people are Turkish-speaking Muslims, although there is no official state religion. Turkey has a varied landscape and climate, and is a popular tourist destination. Many types of crops are grown, and the country is self-sufficient in food.

## KEMAL ATATURK

Kemal Ataturk was the founder and first president of the modern state of Turkey after the collapse of the Ottoman Empire in the early 20th century. He brought about many reforms in Turkish society, including greater freedom for women and better education for all.



This depiction of Kemal Ataturk towers over Antalya, in southern Turkey.



Kurdish children living in Harran in Turkey

## THE KURDS

The Kurds, numbering about 25 million, are one of the largest groups of people in the world who have no homeland. They live in a mountainous area split between four countries: Turkey, Iran, Iraq, and Syria. The Kurds have sought to form their own state – Kurdistan.



## AGRICULTURE

About half of the Turkish workforce is employed in agriculture – growing crops such as wheat, cotton, tobacco, sugar beet, and fruit. Tea is grown along the Black Sea coast and is a popular drink. Much of the work in the fields is done by women. With plenty of fertile farmland, Turkey can produce enough food not only for its own needs, but for export, too.



## EPHESUS

Each year, millions of tourists visit Turkey for its sunny weather, sandy beaches, and ancient sites. These include the ruined city of Ephesus on the Aegean coast, famous for its huge, open-air theater, carved out of the hillside in the first century, with seating for 24,000 people. Tourism is one of Turkey's major industries.

## MARKETS

Bustling street markets, or bazaars, are a common sight in many Turkish towns and cities. Turkey is famous for its arts and crafts, particularly for its fine carpets, pottery, beaten copperware, and leatherwork. Carpets are woven from silk, wool, and cotton and decorated with beautiful geometric and floral designs, often symbolizing the maker's family or area of origin.



This carpet stall is in the Grand Bazaar in Kusadasi, in western Turkey.

## STREET CAFES

Street cafés are popular meeting places, especially with men. They visit them to drink tea or Turkish coffee, smoke pipes, and chat. Games, such as cards or backgammon, are often played.

Men smoke pipes called hubble-bubbles. Smoke is drawn into the mouth through a long tube.

Rich, dark Turkish coffee is a popular drink.



Men often play cards in street cafés.